

PRIMARY

Game Proposal

Team Details

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GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/sahusaurya/primary>

Game Overview

PRIMARY is a stylized 2D action-puzzle platformer set inside a world inspired by the visual language of comic books and traditional print.

The entire world of PRIMARY is constructed using **halftone dots, heavy outlines, comic-style effects, and CMYK-inspired colours**. At the beginning of the game, however, almost all colour and light have mysteriously disappeared. The player wakes up in a dark, nearly monochrome world and discovers that the four fundamental sources of colour and light have been scattered across it.

The player's objective is to recover these lost **CMYK Light Orbs**, gradually restoring colour to the world.

Each colour is much more than a visual collectible. Recovering a colour fundamentally changes how the player can move, interact with the environment, solve puzzles, and fight enemies.

The game revolves around three central ideas:

****Light changes the world.**

Colour changes the player.

And not everything should be restored.******

Core Gameplay Concept

The player begins with extremely limited abilities in a dark world where most objects are inactive.

Early in the game, they discover their first ****Light Orb****, such as Cyan.

When a colour is activated, all objects composed of that colour's halftone pattern become interactive.

For example, Cyan platforms that previously appeared faint or inaccessible may suddenly become solid. Cyan switches can now be activated, paths can appear, and certain obstacles can be manipulated.

However, every colour also affects the player.

Each Light Orb grants a unique movement or gameplay property.

For example:

- **Cyan** may make movement highly slippery, allowing the player to build momentum and slide through certain areas.
- **Magenta** may grant a dash or burst movement ability.
- **Yellow** may greatly increase the player's jump height.
- **Black / Key** may allow the player to interact with shadows, hidden platforms, or dark structures.

These abilities create situations where obtaining a new colour opens previously inaccessible areas while also introducing new movement challenges.

As more colours are recovered, their effects can also be combined to create increasingly complex puzzles and traversal mechanics.

Combat and Colour Interaction

Enemies in PRIMARY are also constructed using halftone colour patterns.

Instead of simply attacking enemies repeatedly, the player must understand the enemy's colour composition.

Enemies can only be damaged effectively using the appropriate **complementary colour or colour interaction**.

For example, an enemy made primarily from Yellow halftones may require the player to activate or attack using a colour that counters Yellow.

Later enemies may contain multiple colours, forcing the player to switch between abilities during combat.

This turns colour into both a combat system and a puzzle system.

Boss encounters can expand on this mechanic by having enemies change their colour composition during battle, requiring the player to adapt their movement and attacks accordingly.

Game Flow

The game begins in an almost completely dark and desaturated environment.

1. The Dark World

The player explores a small starting area with limited movement options.

The environment introduces the game's comic-book visual style through halftone textures, panel-like framing, sound-effect text, and exaggerated visual effects.

The player eventually discovers the first Light Orb.

2. Recovering the Colours

Each major section of the world contains one of the missing Light Orbs.

Obtaining an orb introduces:

- A new colour to the environment
- A new player ability
- New interactable objects
- New enemy types
- New puzzle possibilities

Previously visited areas may also contain paths that can only be accessed after unlocking later colours.

3. Combining Colours

As the player obtains more Light Orbs, puzzles begin requiring combinations of abilities.

A platforming sequence might require the player to use Cyan's slippery movement to gain momentum and then switch to Yellow's enhanced jump to reach a distant platform.

Enemies may similarly require players to quickly switch between colours depending on their composition.

4. Restoring the World

Near the end of the game, the player possesses all of the missing colours.

For the first time, the environment begins to resemble a fully coloured comic-book world.

The player reaches the apparent source of the darkness and prepares to restore light permanently.

Narrative and Plot Twist

Throughout the game, the player is led to believe that restoring all colour and light will save the world.

The protagonist becomes increasingly connected to the Light Orbs as they collect them, using their energy to gain new abilities.

However, the final reveal is that the protagonist is not simply carrying the Light Orbs.

They are ****absorbing them****.

The world cannot regain its light while the colour remains inside the player.

The antagonist, or another major character, reveals that the protagonist must release all of the collected light simultaneously to restore the world.

Doing so will destroy them.

The final sequence therefore becomes a deliberate sacrifice.

The player activates all four colours one final time.

For the first time in the game, the screen becomes completely filled with colour.

The world is restored.

But the protagonist disappears with the light they carried.

The final scene shows the fully coloured world continuing without them.

Theme Justification

Comic

The **Comic** theme defines the visual identity of PRIMARY.

The world is inspired by comic-book printing techniques, particularly **halftone dot patterns and CMYK printing**.

Environments, enemies, effects, and characters are constructed using halftone textures and strong outlines.

Additional comic-inspired presentation can include:

- Panel-style transitions

- Speech bubbles
- Comic sound effects such as ****BAM****, ****WHOOSH****, or ****CRACK****
- Impact frames during combat
- Printed-paper textures
- Limited colour palettes

The comic theme is therefore incorporated into both the game's art direction and its core mechanics.

Light

****Light**** is the central gameplay and narrative mechanic.

The world begins without light and colour, and the player's main objective is to recover the lost Light Orbs.

Light determines:

- Which parts of the world are visible or active
- Which objects can be interacted with
- Which abilities the player possesses
- How enemies can be defeated
- How the game's environment evolves

As the player progresses, the world gradually changes from dark and monochrome into a vibrant CMYK comic world.

Twist

The central ****Twist**** occurs at the end of the game.

The player spends the entire game collecting light under the assumption that completing the collection will allow them to save the world.

Instead, they discover that the light cannot return while they are carrying it.

The protagonist must sacrifice themselves and release all of the Light Orbs to restore colour permanently.

This changes the meaning of the player's entire journey.

The colours that made the protagonist progressively stronger ultimately become the reason they must give themselves up.

Summary

PRIMARY is a comic-inspired action-puzzle platformer where ****colour functions simultaneously as light, movement, combat, and progression****.

By connecting the CMYK printing system with halftone comic visuals, the game's mechanics naturally reinforce its art style.

The gradual return of colour gives the player a clear sense of progression while introducing new abilities and interactions throughout the game.

The final sacrifice provides the narrative twist, completing the game's three required themes:

****Comic through its halftone and printed visual identity.****

****Light through the recovery and manipulation of colour-based Light Orbs.****

****Twist through the revelation that restoring the world requires the protagonist to sacrifice themselves.****